Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

A215A
Creative Writing
Main- All Branches
Final Exam

2024-2025 /Second Semester
2 June 2025
9:30 – 12:30

Number of Exam Pages: 5 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 3 hours**

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Read the questions carefully before you answer.
2. Answer all the questions in the answer booklet.
3. Write all your answers in ink NOT pencil.
4. Edit and proofread your language.

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I. Write Short Notes on the following (30 – 50 words each): (15 Marks)

a) The impact of the setting on the character's mood (3 Marks)
b) The purpose of an analytical film review (3 Marks)
c) Structure of an analytical film review (4 Marks)
d) Parts of a news article (5 Marks)

II. Using the character's checklist, invent a character who uses these things:

1- White board
2- Marker
3- A poetry book
4- Computer
5- Red pen
6- Notebook
7- Flash cards
8- Mug

In 250-300 words, write about this character, incorporating some of the above objects into your description. Integrate mini-dialogues with other characters, reflecting some kind of conflict. Make sure that your language shows more than tells. (10 Marks)

III. Read the following film review below, and then answer the following questions:

A) Do you believe that the film review creates a strong impression on readers? Justify your answer highlighting the message/theme of the film and whether the film reviewer recommends the movie or not. Provide examples by quoting from the review to explain your answer. (7 Marks)
B) Re-write this review in your own words, using the language of film review, creating the same impression and delivering the same message. (8 Marks)

Spider-Man: No Way Home

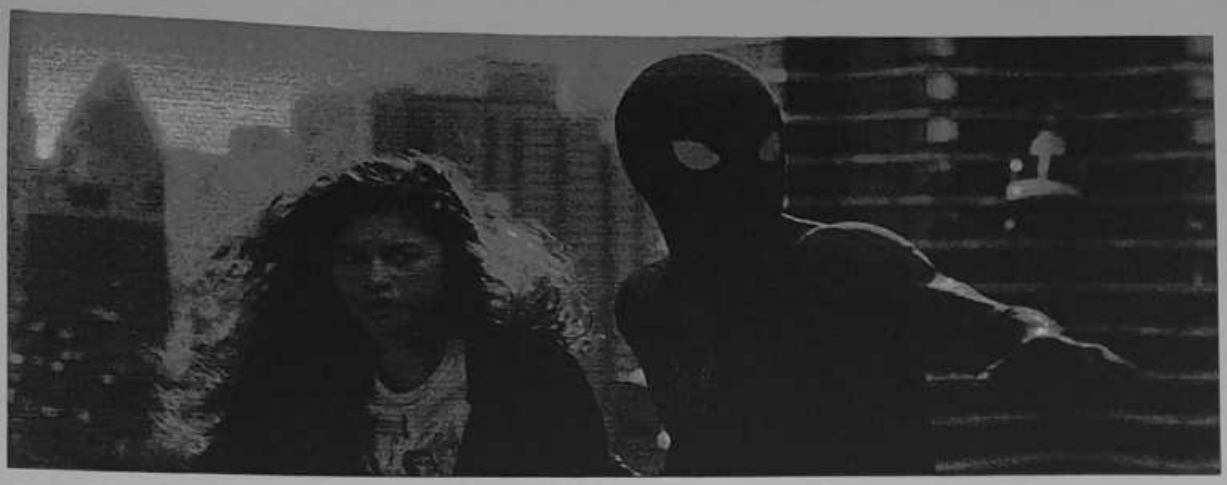
ACTION

148 minutes · PG-13 · 2021

Brian Tallerico

December 14, 2021

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The best of "Spider-Man: No Way Home" reminded me why I used to love comic books, especially the ones about a boy named Peter Parker. There was a playful unpredictability to them that has often been missing from modern superhero movies, which feel so precisely calculated. Yes, of course, "No Way Home" is *incredibly* calculated, a way to make more headlines after killing off so many of its event characters in Phase 3, but it's also a film that's often bursting with creative joy.

Director Jon Watts and his team have delivered a true event movie, a double-sized crossover issue of a comic book that the young me would have waited in line to read first, excitedly turning every page with breathless anticipation of the next twist and turn. And yet they generally avoid getting weighed down by the expectations fans have for this film, somehow sidestepping the cluttered traps of other crowded part threes. "No Way Home" is crowded, but it's also surprisingly spry, inventive, and just purely entertaining, leading to a final act that not only earns its emotions but pays off some of the ones you may have about this character that you forgot.

"No Way Home" picks up immediately after the end of "Spider-Man: Far From Home," with the sound of that film's closing scene playing over the Marvel logo. Mysterio has revealed the identity of the man in the red tights, which means nothing will ever be the same for Peter Parker (Tom Holland). With an almost slapstick energy, "No Way Home" opens with a series of scenes about the pitfalls of super-fame, particularly how it impacts Peter's girlfriend M.J. (Zendaya) and best bud Ned (Jacob Batalon). It reaches a peak when M.I.T. denies all three of them admission, citing the controversy about Peter's identity and the roles his buddies played in his super-adventures.

Peter has a plan. The "wizard" he met when he saved half the population with The Avengers can cast a spell and make it all go away. So he asks Dr. Strange (Benedict Cumberbatch) to make the world forget that Spider-Man is Peter Parker, which, of course, immediately backfires. He doesn't want M.J. or Ned or Aunt May (Marisa Tomei) to forget everything they've been through together, and so the spell gets derailed in the middle of it. Strange barely gets it under control. And then Doc Ock (Alfred Molina) and the Green Goblin (Willem Dafoe) show up.

As the previews have revealed, "Spider-Man: No Way Home" weaves characters and mythology from the other cinematic iterations of this character into the universe of the current one, but I'm happy to report that it's more than a casting gimmick. My concern going in was that this would merely be a case of "Batman Forever" or even "Spider-Man 3," where more was often the enemy of good. It's not. The villains that return from the Sam Raimi and Marc Webb films don't overcrowd the narrative as much as they speak to

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a theme that emerges in the film that ties this entire series back to the other ones. For a generation, the line about Spidey was "With great power comes great responsibility." "Spider-Man: No Way Home" is about the modern Peter Parker learning what that means. (It also helps a *great* deal to have actors like Molina and Dafoe in villain roles again given how the lack of memorable villains has been a problem in the MCU.)

So many modern superhero movies have confronted what it means to be a superhero, but this is the first time it's really been foregrounded in the current run of Peter Parker, which turns "No Way Home" into something of a graduation story. It's the one in which Parker has to grow up and deal with not just the fame that comes with Spider-Man but how his decisions will have more impact than most kids planning to go to college. It asks some interesting questions about empathy as Peter is put in a position to basically try to save the men who tried to kill other multiverse iterations of him. And it playfully becomes a commentary on correcting mistakes of the past not just in the life of Holland's Parker but those of characters (and even filmmakers) made long before he stepped into the role. "No way Home" is about the weight of heroic decisions. Even the right ones mean you may not be able to go home again.

"Spider-Man: No Way Home" could have just been a greatest hits, a way to pull different projects into the same IP just because the producers can. Some will see it that way just on premise alone, but there's more going on here than the previews would have you believe. It's about what historic heroes and villains mean to us in the first place—why we care so much and what we consider a victory over evil. More than any movie in the MCU that I can remember, it made me want to dig out my old box of Spider-Man comic books. That's a heroic accomplishment.

In theaters on December 17th

Source:
https://www.rogerebert.com/reviews/spider-man-no-way-home-movie-review-2021

IV. Read the following extract from a feature story, and then answer the questions that follow:

Celebrating Neighbors: A Country Girl with a Giving Nature

As a wife, mother of two, and full-time caregiver for her parents, Angela Creed might seem to have barely enough time to maintain her own rigorous schedule. Yet, according to her Columbia neighbor Mary Beth Kirkpatrick, Creed makes time to give more of herself to neighbors, community organizations, local schools, and most importantly, those in need. "Angela is known throughout the community as someone who is quick to send a care package and handwritten note of encouragement to neighbors or friends who are sick, going through some sort of difficulty or just celebrating some special event," Kirkpatrick said in her letter nominating Creed for the Suburban Journals Celebrate Your Neighbor Award.

Source: https://shannonphilpott.com/tag/sample-feature-stories/ (10 Marks)

1- Write a full definition of a feature story. (3 Marks)
2- List the characteristics of a feature story and then explore them in the above extract. Write sentences from the extract to support your answer. (7Marks)

End of Exam

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